COURSE

AQA A-level Business (7132)

Improving motivation and engagement

3.6 Human resource management · 3.6.4 Making human resource decisions: improving motivation and engagement

Revision for 3.6 Human resource management: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class	Topic
AQA A-level Business (7132)	**Improving motivation and engagement**

THE LESSON

Setup				3 min
Round 1				Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 1 **Herzberg: hygiene**	TASK 2 **Staff feel ignored**	
Round 2				Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 3 **Maslow in order**	TASK 4 **Piece-rate pay**	**B2B deal**
Round 3				Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min
Firm decisions	**Deals**	TASK 5 **Pay or promotion**	TASK 6 **Maslow: next need**	**B2B deal**
Final questions				3 min

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

You raise pay and fix the cold workshop. Complaints stop, but staff work no harder.

Using Herzberg, why did output not rise?

PICK ONE

- ✔ **Pay and conditions are hygiene factors**
- ○ Pay is a motivator, but too small
- ○ Staff need closer supervision
- ○ Staff's esteem needs are already met

Why: Hygiene factors remove dissatisfaction but do not motivate.

Task 2

ROUND 1

A staff survey says pay is fine, but staff feel ignored.

Which two changes should motivate most?

PICK TWO

- ○ A 2% pay rise for all
- ○ A bonus for every car sold
- ✔ **Ask staff to help set targets**
- ○ Closer checks on their work
- ✔ **Let teams plan their own work**

Why: Feeling ignored is not about pay: involvement and trust tackle it.

Task 3

ROUND 2

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, at your firm.

Put the needs in order, lowest first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **Physiological: pay for the basics**
2. **Safety: a secure contract**
3. **Social: a friendly team**
4. **Esteem: praise for good work**

Why: Maslow: physiological, safety, social, then esteem, then self-actualisation.

Task 4

ROUND 2

Prep staff are paid per car finished.

Her pay this week?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Pay per car prepared	**£16**
Cars she prepared this week	**46 cars**
Extra per car above 30 cars	**£5**

METHOD

Pay = cars × pay per car + cars above the target × extra

46 × £16 + 16 × £5 = £816

Why: Piece rate pays for output, so staff work faster, sometimes at the cost of quality.

Task 5

ROUND 3

Sales staff are leaving. Exit interviews say pay is fair, but there is no chance to progress.

What should you offer, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ○ A higher basic salary
- ✔ **Training and a clear promotion path**

Why: Pay is not the problem; a chance to grow and progress meets the need staff named.

Task 6

ROUND 3

A technician has a secure, well-paid job and friends at work, but feels no one values her skill.

Using Maslow, which need should you meet next?

PICK ONE

- ✔ **Esteem needs**
- ○ Physiological needs
- ○ Safety needs
- ○ Social needs

Why: Safety and social needs are met; recognition is an esteem need, which comes next.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

109
Level 3 Business questions

0
of them on improving motivation and engagement

The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions. None of them is about improving motivation and engagement yet.